

UK Civil Society Organisation Register

A Guide to the Dataset

September 2026

1. Overview

This dataset is a deduplicated register of every formally registered civil society organisation in the United Kingdom. It was produced by the [UK Third and Civil Society Sector Database](https://uk-third-sector-database.github.io/) (TCSS) project, which collects, processes, and links public administrative data on civil society organisations across the United Kingdom.

The Organisation Register — referred to as the “Data Spine” — brings together records from ten UK regulatory bodies into a single dataset. Each organisation receives a unique identifier (UID) that enables records to be linked across data sources. A matching algorithm identifies organisations that appear in more than one register and links them under a single UID, producing a comprehensive, deduplicated picture of the sector.

The register is distributed as a set of four CSV files that together describe the organisations, their cross-register links, and their industrial classifications. All data in the register are derived from openly available public sources.

2. What is the Organisation Register?

The UK civil society sector is governed by a patchwork of regulatory bodies. Charities in England and Wales are registered with the Charity Commission for England and Wales (CCEW); charities in Scotland with the Office of the Scottish Charity Regulator (OSCR); and charities in Northern Ireland with the Charity Commission for Northern Ireland (CCNI). Companies — including Community Interest Companies, charitable companies, and other nonprofits limited by guarantee — are registered at Companies House. Co-operatives and mutual societies appear on the Co-operatives UK register and the FCA Mutuals Public Register. Sector-specific bodies such as the Care Quality Commission, Care Inspectorate Scotland, and the social housing regulators in England and Scotland maintain further records.

Many organisations appear in more than one of these registers. A charity incorporated as a company limited by guarantee, for example, will have records at both a charity commission and Companies House. Without linkage, these appear as separate entities, leading to double-counting and fragmented analysis.

The Organisation Register solves this problem by:

- Ingesting data from all ten source registers
- Normalising names, addresses, and dates into a common format
- Running a matching algorithm to identify duplicate records across registers
- Assigning a single UID to each unique organisation
- Storing primary records in the spine file and alternative records in the supplementary file

The result is the first comprehensive, deduplicated listing of UK civil society organisations available as open data. Further details of the construction methodology are available in the [Spine Builder documentation](https://uk-third-sector-database.github.io/_posts/2024/001/blog-post-3/) and the project's [GitHub repository](https://github.com/uk-third-sector-database).

3. Dataset Contents

781,176

Organisations

10

Source Registers

139,862

Cross-Register Links

384,096

Currently Active

The register is distributed as four CSV files:

File	Records	Description
TSCS_spine.spine.csv	781,176	The deduplicated organisation register — one row per unique organisation
TSCS_spine.supplementary.csv	1,112,618	Alternative names, addresses, and dates from other source registers
TSCS_spine.matches.csv	139,862	Cross-register links between duplicate records, with match type
TSCS_spine.SIC_codes.csv	474,842	Standard Industrial Classification codes derived from Companies House, one code per row

Organisation Types

The `cso_type` field classifies organisations into four main types: Charity, CIC, Co-operative/Mutual, and Other. The `cso_subtype` field provides a finer-grained classification: Charities, CICs, and Co-operatives/Mutuals pass through unchanged, while the 'Other' category is disaggregated into subtypes using Companies House SIC (Standard Industrial Classification) codes and organisation name patterns. The classification applies SIC division codes (the first two digits of the primary SIC code) alongside keyword matching on organisation names. Rules are applied in a documented first-match priority order: each organisation receives the first subtype whose rule it satisfies (dormant companies first, then SIC-division rules, then name-pattern rules). Name-pattern rules also apply when an organisation has no usable five-digit SIC code, so an organisation cannot escape classification simply because its SIC information is missing or in a legacy format. Where a charity is linked to a company registered as a Community Interest Company, the register follows the Companies House record: in this release uHub Therapy Centre and RiChmusicNI are both classified as CICs rather than charities.

Table 1 shows the composition of the sector by organisation type, country, and status. Percentages are calculated within each status-country group (for example, of all active organisations in Scotland, 78.6% are charities).

Property management companies dominate the 'Other' category among active organisations in England (44.0% of active 'Other' organisations, equivalent to about 15% of all active English organisations) and are also prominent in Wales (22.3%), reflecting the prevalence of residential leasehold structures; they are far rarer in Scotland (3.0%). The residual 'Other Company Limited By Guarantee' category remains the largest subtype among dissolved 'Other' organisations in every country (61–66%).

Table 1: Civil society organisations by type, country, and status

Panel A: column percentages within each status-country group. Panel B: column percentages within the 'Other' category.								
	Active				Dissolved			
	England	N. Ireland	Scotland	Wales	England	N. Ireland	Scotland	Wales
Panel A: Organisation type								
Community Interest Company	11.7%	6.3%	7.0%	11.9%	9.7%	13.9%	6.5%	8.9%
Charity	50.5%	72.9%	78.6%	54.9%	48.4%	34.3%	72.9%	55.4%
Co-operative / Mutual	3.0%	4.8%	2.5%	5.1%	3.7%	2.2%	2.6%	4.6%
Other	34.8%	16.1%	11.9%	28.2%	38.2%	49.6%	18.0%	31.0%
Organisations (N)	311,970	9,338	29,279	14,497	313,500	3,872	26,855	15,315
Panel B: Subtypes of 'Other' (% within Other)								
Other Company Limited By Guarantee	29.0%	31.4%	48.0%	37.6%	64.6%	61.4%	65.7%	61.1%
Property Management Company	44.0%	10.9%	3.0%	22.3%	5.9%	2.1%	1.6%	4.8%
Education Institution	7.3%	13.1%	9.3%	6.3%	9.3%	8.0%	6.2%	8.4%
Sports Club	5.2%	14.5%	13.0%	15.9%	2.6%	5.2%	5.1%	5.1%
Arts Organisation	2.3%	6.3%	6.8%	4.5%	3.3%	5.3%	6.2%	5.1%
Membership Organisation	3.1%	6.3%	7.2%	3.6%	2.5%	3.5%	4.5%	3.1%
Social Services Organisation	1.8%	3.7%	2.0%	1.7%	3.5%	3.7%	2.1%	3.2%
Health Organisation	1.4%	2.9%	2.2%	1.6%	2.9%	3.9%	3.4%	3.5%
Dormant Company	2.1%	3.7%	1.9%	3.8%	2.3%	3.8%	2.7%	2.6%
Religious Organisation	1.6%	4.3%	2.0%	0.9%	2.0%	2.4%	1.2%	1.0%
Professional / Trade Body	2.2%	2.8%	4.3%	1.8%	1.1%	0.8%	1.3%	2.1%
Housing Association	0.1%	0.1%	0.1%	0.0%	0.1%	0.0%	0.1%	0.0%
'Other' organisations (N)	108,478	1,499	3,488	4,083	119,837	1,922	4,826	4,750

Source: UK Civil Society Organisation Register v1.3. Country is assigned from the registered-address postcode via the National Statistics Postcode Lookup; organisations without a mappable UK postcode (around 7% of records, including most housing-regulator records) are excluded from this table. Subtype labels are the values of the `cso_subtype` field.

3.1 Organisation Register (Spine)

The main file contains one row per unique organisation. Where an organisation appears in multiple registers, the record from the highest-precedence source is used (see [Section A2](#)). Fields include the organisation name, registered address, registration and removal dates, source register, and a flag indicating whether the organisation is a Community Interest Company.

Field Descriptions

Field	Description	Type
uid	Unique identifier for each organisation, constructed from the source code and original ID (e.g. GB-CHC-200009 , GB-COH-00686799)	Text
organisationname	Primary name of the organisation as recorded by the source register	Text
normalisedname	Name normalised to uppercase with extra spaces and punctuation removed, used for matching	Text
fulladdress	Full registered address as found in the highest-precedence source	Text
city	City or town from the registered address	Text
postcode	UK postcode of the registered address	Text
registerdate	Earliest registration date found across all sources for this organisation (dd/mm/yyyy)	Date
removeddate	Dissolution or removal date according to the newest authoritative source record; blank if currently active (dd/mm/yyyy). Removal dates from older, superseded records are retained in the supplementary file rather than here	Date
source_register	Name of the source register providing the primary record (e.g. "Charity Commission for England and Wales")	Text
is_cic	Boolean flag indicating whether the organisation is a Community Interest Company (True / False)	Boolean
cso_type	High-level organisation type: Charity , CIC , Co-operative / Mutual , or Other . Derived from source_register and is_cic	Text
cso_subtype	Detailed organisation subtype. Charities, CICs, and co-operatives pass through unchanged. 'Other' is disaggregated into subtypes using SIC codes and organisation name patterns (see Organisation Types)	Text

Sample Data

The table below shows one example organisation from each of the eight primary source registers, plus two Community Interest Companies.

uid	organisationname	postcode	registerdate	source_register	is_cic	cso_type	cso_subtype
GB-CHC-200009	THE RALPH LEVY CHARITABLE COMPANY LIMITED	W1U 2AY	17/03/1961	Charity Commission for England and Wales	False	Charity	Charity
GB-SC-SC000001	Stoneyburn Community Education Centre Assoc	EH47 8BN	26/06/1986	Scottish Charity Register	False	Charity	Charity
GB-NIC-100002	Cancer Lifeline	BT14 7PJ	04/05/2005	Charity Commission for Northern Ireland	False	Charity	Charity
GB-COH-00004302	LIVERPOOL LAW SOCIETY	L3 9QJ	13/02/1869	Companies House	False	Other	Professional / Trade Body
GB-COOP-R020362	Uniteddiversity LLP	DT6 3LS	31/07/2002	Co-operatives	False	Co-operative / Mutual	Co-operative / Mutual

uid	organisationname	postcode	registerdate	source_register	is_cic	cso_type	cso_subtype
GB-MPR-1231W	"Sankey" Working Men's Club and Institute	WS8 6JB	12/04/1937	Mutuals Public Register	False	Co-operative / Mutual	Co-operative / Mutual
GB-SHR-275	Abronhill Housing Association Ltd			Scottish Housing Regulator	False	Other	Housing Association
GB-SHPE-L0976	Bexley Community Housing Association Limited		08/12/1975	Social Housing England	False	Other	Housing Association
GB-COH-00288977	THE POST OFFICE FELLOWSHIP OF REMEMBRANCE C.I.C	GL20 8SD	09/06/1934	Companies House	True	CIC	CIC
GB-CHC-518004	FRIENDS OF CORONATION ROAD PLAYGROUND	B30 2SG	06/10/1986	Charity Commission for England and Wales	True	CIC	CIC

Note: Some fields are blank where the source register does not provide that information. The Scottish Housing Regulator, for example, does not supply postcode or registration date data.

3.2 Supplementary Records

Where an organisation has additional names, addresses, or dates from other source registers or historical data iterations, these are stored in the supplementary file. This includes "Also Known As" names, previous addresses, and alternative registration or removal dates. Each supplementary row is linked to the main spine record by the `uid` field.

How to read supplementary rows. An organisation's historical names, addresses and dates are collected as independent sets: a row's name and address are not asserted to belong together, and a row may populate only some fields. Treat each populated value as "a name (or address, or date) recorded for this organisation at some point", not as a coherent historical record. Note also that rows may carry the `uid` of an organisation that was merged into another during linkage — the full set of organisations represented in a release is the spine *plus* the uids appearing in the matches file. Historical variants that current register downloads no longer publish are carried forward from the previous release, so this history is never lost by a rebuild.

Field Descriptions

Field	Description	Type
<code>uid</code>	UID of the organisation this variant belongs to. This is either a spine UID or the UID of a record that was absorbed into another organisation during linkage; in the latter case it joins to the spine via the matches file rather than directly	Text
<code>organisationname</code>	Alternative name for the organisation	Text
<code>normalisedname</code>	Normalised version of the alternative name	Text
<code>fulladdress</code>	Alternative address	Text
<code>city</code>	City from the alternative address	Text
<code>postcode</code>	Postcode from the alternative address	Text
<code>registerdate</code>	Alternative registration date (dd/mm/yyyy)	Date

Field	Description	Type
removeddate	Alternative removal or dissolution date (dd/mm/yyyy)	Date
source_register	Source register from which this supplementary record was drawn	Text
id_in_source	Reserved for the organisation's ID in the original source register; unpopulated in this release	Text

Sample Data

The example below shows supplementary records for two organisations. The charity GB-CHC-200009 has three alternative addresses from historical CCEW data, while its corresponding Companies House record (GB-COH-00686799) provides an alternative name.

uid	organisationname	fulladdress	postcode	source_register
GB-CHC-200009		5-6 DOWN STREET, LONDON	W1J 7AH	Charity Commission for England and Wales
GB-CHC-200009		14 CHESTERFIELD STREET, LONDON	W1J 5JN	Charity Commission for England and Wales
GB-CHC-200009		116 PICCADILLY, LONDON	W1J 7BJ	Charity Commission for England and Wales
GB-COH-00686799	RALPH LEVY CHARITABLE COMPANY LIMITED(THE)	1 HINDE STREET, HINDE STREET		Companies House
GB-CHC-200012	WRESTLINGWORTH CHURCH & POORS CHARITY			Charity Commission for England and Wales

Tip: Most supplementary rows join to the spine directly on `uid`, but a supplementary `uid` is not guaranteed to appear in the spine: it may belong to a record absorbed during linkage, in which case the matches file provides the route to the spine parent. Each organisation may have multiple supplementary rows — one for each alternative name, address, or date found across source registers. The relationship is one-to-many.

3.3 Cross-Register Matches

The matches file records every link identified between organisations across different source registers. Each row represents a pair of matched records, with the UIDs, source IDs, and source registers for both sides of the match, along with the method used to establish the link.

Field Descriptions

Field	Description	Type
uid	Final spine UID of the record that represents this matched pair in the register (the “absorbing” parent). Blank for association-only links, which record shared evidence between two records without consolidating either endpoint (2,164 rows in this release)	Text
orgA_id_in_source	ID in the original source for Organisation A	Text
orgA_source	Source register code for Organisation A (e.g. <code>ccew</code> , <code>CH</code>)	Text
orgA_uid	UID assigned to Organisation A	Text
orgB_id_in_source	ID in the original source for Organisation B	Text

Field	Description	Type
orgB_source	Source register code for Organisation B	Text
orgB_uid	UID assigned to Organisation B	Text
match_type	Method used to identify the match (see Section A3)	Text

Sample Data

Each row links two organisation records from different sources (or, occasionally, the same source). The example rows below illustrate the main match types. The last row is not a match but a consolidation: Equality Period Limited (GB-NIC-108424) is linked to its Northern Irish company by name, and WIRRAL CLUB LIMITED (GB-CHC-1177821) absorbed the separate Mutuals Public Register entry GB-MPR-29858R after the Companies House record GB-COH-11092810 was found to match both of them.

orgA_uid	orgA_source	orgB_uid	orgB_source	match_type
GB-CHC-200009	ccew	GB-COH-00686799	CH	companyid - id_in_source
GB-CHC-200103	ccew	GB-SHPE-A2072	socialhousingengland	ftc
GB-SC-SC000015	OSCR	GB-COH-SC114294	CH	oscr
GB-MPR-9808	mutuals	GB-COOP-R042728	CoOps	companyid - coop mutual
GB-CHC-200453	ccew	GB-CQC-1-151675564	carequalitycommission	name - care
GB-CHC-200103	ccew	GB-SHPE-A2072	socialhousingengland	name - housing
GB-CHC-200124	ccew	GB-CHC-285317	ccew	companyid - companyid
GB-NIC-108424	ccni	GB-COH-NI679140	CH	name - ni charity
GB-CHC-1177821	ccew	GB-MPR-29858R	mutuals	merge via bridge

Match Type Distribution

Match Type	Count	Description
ftc	73,307	Find That Charity lookup table (includes historic re-registrations)
companyid - id_in_source	37,759	Charity register links to Companies House via company number
companyid - coop mutual	11,198	Co-operative's registered society number links to the Mutuals Public Register or Companies House
oscr	4,294	OSCR cross-border flag or company identifier matching
name - care	3,425	Normalised name match with CQC or Care Inspectorate Scotland
companyid - cqc	1,967	CQC provider's recorded Companies House number identifies the company directly
name - ni charity	1,811	Northern Irish company matched to the Northern Ireland charity of the same normalised name, where that name identifies exactly one organisation on each side
charityno - cqc	1,494	CQC provider's recorded charity number identifies the charity directly
name - crossborder	1,466	Scottish charity flagged as also registered in England & Wales, matched to CCEW by name
name - housing	1,435	Normalised name match between housing regulators and the charity registers or the FCA Mutuals Public Register

Match Type	Count	Description
companyid - companyid	1,328	Two records sharing the same registered company number
merge via bridge	378	Not a matching method but a record of consolidation: a third record matched two organisations from different registers on strong enough evidence, so the two were combined into one and this row names the record that was folded in

3.4 SIC Codes

Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) codes derived from Companies House records. Each row contains exactly one atomic SIC code: 458,697 rows carry a five-digit SIC 2007 code and 16,145 rows carry a four-digit code from older SIC taxonomies, retained as provenance. An organisation may have several codes, so the relationship to the spine is one-to-many (474,842 rows covering 359,287 organisations). SIC codes enable classification of organisations by industry sector.

Field Descriptions

Field	Description	Type
uid	Organisation UID, remapped to the final spine record. Where a company was matched to a charity or other higher-precedence record, its SIC codes are recorded under that parent UID (56,314 rows, 11.9%, carry a non- GB-COH- UID such as GB-CHC-)	Text
SIC	A single four- or five-digit SIC code (e.g. 94120 for "Activities of professional membership organisations"). Five-digit codes are SIC 2007; four-digit codes are legacy taxonomy values retained as provenance	Text

Note: SIC codes originate from Companies House filings, but because UIDs are remapped to the final spine parent, the file joins directly to the spine on uid wherever the organisation is represented there — a charity matched to a company therefore carries that company's SIC codes under its own charity UID, with no extra join required. The matches file retains the underlying Companies House provenance for anyone who needs it.

4. Coverage & Composition

The register covers 781,176 organisations, of which 384,096 (49.2%) are currently active (no removal date) and 397,080 (50.8%) are dissolved or removed.

Organisations by Source Register

Source Register	Organisations	% of Total
Charity Commission for England and Wales	351,761	45.0%
Companies House	334,340	42.8%
Scottish Charity Register	53,846	6.9%
Mutuals Public Register	32,152	4.1%
Charity Commission for Northern Ireland	8,339	1.1%
Co-operatives	604	0.1%

Source Register	Organisations	% of Total
Social Housing England	23	<0.1%
Scottish Housing Regulator	111	<0.1%

Note on source counts: These figures count the number of organisations whose *primary* record comes from each source. An organisation matched across registers appears only once, under its highest-precedence source. The Care Inspectorate Scotland and Care Quality Commission do not contribute primary records — they only appear in the matches file where they link to an existing spine record.

Community Interest Companies

Of the 781,176 organisations in the register, 78,595 (10.1%) are flagged as Community Interest Companies. The `is_cic` field provides a direct way to filter for this subset.

Companies House Company Types

Organisations sourced from Companies House are filtered to include only civil-society-relevant company types. The included types and their approximate counts are:

Company Type	Approximate Count
Company Limited by Guarantee	436,900
Community Interest Company	93,200
Charitable Incorporated Organisation	38,300
Registered Society	11,000
Scottish Charitable Incorporated Organisation	7,000
Industrial and Provident Society	160

Excluded company types include Private Limited Companies, Public Limited Companies, Limited Partnerships, and other company forms that are not typically associated with the civil society sector. The full inclusion and exclusion criteria are listed in [Section A4](#).

5. Unique Identifiers

Each organisation in the spine is assigned a UID that encodes its source register and original registration number. The UID format follows the org-id.guide (<https://org-id.guide/>) convention where possible.

UID Prefix Scheme

Prefix	Source Register	Example
GB-CHC-	Charity Commission for England and Wales	GB-CHC-200009
GB-SC-	Scottish Charity Register (OSCR)	GB-SC-SC003558

Prefix	Source Register	Example
GB-NIC-	Charity Commission for Northern Ireland	GB-NIC-100001
GB-COH-	Companies House	GB-COH-00686799
GB-COOP-	Co-operatives UK	GB-COOP-1234
GB-MPR-	Mutuals Public Register (FCA)	GB-MPR-12345R
GB-SHR-	Scottish Housing Regulator	GB-SHR-123
GB-SHPE-	Social Housing England	GB-SHPE-A1234
GB-CIS-	Care Inspectorate Scotland	GB-CIS-CS2012345678
GB-CQC-	Care Quality Commission	GB-CQC-1-123456789

Tip: You can parse the UID prefix to determine which source register an organisation was originally drawn from. When an organisation appears in multiple registers, the UID will correspond to the highest-precedence source (see [Section A2](#)).

6. Data Sources

The register draws on open data from ten UK regulatory bodies. The table below lists each source and its URL.

Source	URL
Charity Commission for England and Wales	register-of-charities.charitycommission.gov.uk (https://register-of-charities.charitycommission.gov.uk/en/register/full-register-download)
Scottish Charity Register (OSCR)	www.oscr.org.uk (https://www.oscr.org.uk/)
Charity Commission for Northern Ireland	www.charitycommissionni.org.uk (https://www.charitycommissionni.org.uk/)
Companies House	download.companieshouse.gov.uk (https://download.companieshouse.gov.uk/en_output.html)
Co-operatives UK	www.uk.coop/resources/open-data (https://www.uk.coop/resources/open-data)
Mutuals Public Register (FCA)	mutuals.fca.org.uk (https://mutuals.fca.org.uk/)
Scottish Housing Regulator	www.housingregulator.gov.scot (https://www.housingregulator.gov.scot/landlord-performance/statistical-information/)
Social Housing England	gov.uk — Registered Providers (https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/registered-providers-of-social-housing)
Care Inspectorate Scotland	www.careinspectorate.com (https://www.careinspectorate.com/index.php/statistics-and-analysis/data-and-analysis)
Care Quality Commission	www.cqc.org.uk (https://www.cqc.org.uk/about-us/transparency/using-cqc-data)

The first eight sources in the table above contribute primary records to the spine. The Care Inspectorate Scotland and Care Quality Commission contribute only to the matches file — they are used to link organisations to existing spine records but do not add new organisations to the register.

From v1.3 the Northern Ireland register's company-number column is read as well as its names, addresses and dates. The Charity Commission for Northern Ireland publishes the Companies House number of each charity that is also a registered company; earlier releases discarded it, so Northern Irish charities could only be linked to their companies through a small set of numbers inherited from a 2024 snapshot. These numbers are self-reported by charities and a small proportion (around 0.3%) name a different company; values that cannot be company numbers, and two verified misdeclarations, are excluded.

7. Limitations & Caveats

- **Scope.** The register covers formally registered organisations only. Unregistered voluntary groups, informal associations, and community groups that do not appear on any regulatory register are not included.
- **Coverage by jurisdiction.** Coverage varies between jurisdictions. The CCNI register was established more recently than its counterparts in England, Wales, and Scotland, so the Northern Ireland data has less historical depth. CCNI also does not provide removal dates for deregistered charities. From version 1.3, Northern Irish charities are linked to their Companies House records using the charity regulator's own company-number field and, where no number is published, an exact name match. Northern Ireland links made by name alone agree with the company's registered postcode about 52% of the time, against about 78% for links confirmed by a company number — much of the difference reflects companies registered at an accountant's or solicitor's address rather than the charity's own.
- **Missing data.** Some fields are incomplete. Approximately 13,200 CCEW charity records lack address information (most were removed before 1997). Around 1,800 OSCR records lack organisation names and addresses. The `city` field is frequently blank across all sources.
- **Multiple dates.** A small proportion of CCEW records (3.6%) have more than one registration date. This can arise from data entry corrections, organisations that were removed and re-registered, or merged charities. The spine records the earliest registration date; the removal date follows the newest authoritative source record (see the Current status note below), with other date variants retained in the supplementary file.
- **Registration dates are the earliest across linked records.** Where an organisation is linked across registers, the spine records the earliest registration or incorporation date found. A charity linked to an older company therefore shows the company's incorporation date, not the date it was entered on the charity register. This is most visible for Northern Ireland in this release, where charity–company links have increased sharply; use the source register's own extract where the charity registration date specifically is required.
- **Matching limitations.** The deduplication algorithm identifies most cross-register duplicates but cannot guarantee perfect recall. Some genuine duplicates may remain unlinked (false negatives), particularly where organisation names differ substantially between registers or where no company number link exists. Conversely, a small number of false positive matches are possible where two genuinely distinct organisations share a normalised name. Two organisations that are the same body but recorded under slightly different legal-form wording may still be held apart: Clyde Valley Housing Association appears as both a Scottish charity and a Mutuels Public Register society because one record says "Ltd" and the other "Limited".
- **Point-in-time snapshot.** The register reflects data as available at the time of construction. Organisations registered or removed after the data download dates will not be captured. The current release is built from the same source downloads as version 1.2 — register data downloaded through July 2026, plus historical register content carried forward from earlier releases — and differs from it only in how records are matched to one another (see the changelog).
- **Postcodes and geography.** To link organisations to geographic areas (Local Authority, region, country), the postcode field can be joined to the National Statistics Postcode Lookup (NSPL). However, not all organisations have a valid postcode in the register.

Current status: An organisation's current status is controlled by the newest authoritative record for it. Where an organisation appears in several registers, the most recently updated authoritative source decides whether it is active; removal dates from older, superseded records are kept in the supplementary file rather than in the spine. In particular, for English and Welsh Charitable Incorporated Organisations that also hold a CE -prefix Companies House record, the newer CCEW status takes precedence over older Companies House bulk data. A blank removeddate means the organisation is active according to its newest authoritative source; in a small number of cases it may reflect missing data, so cross-referencing with the original register is recommended for definitive status checks.

8. What Can You Learn?

The Organisation Register enables a range of research and policy applications:

- **Sampling frame for national surveys.** The deduplicated register provides the first comprehensive sampling frame that crosses legal form and organisation type within a single dataset. Researchers can draw stratified samples by organisational type, jurisdiction, geography, industrial classification, and organisational age.
- **Local ecosystem analysis.** By linking organisations to Local Authority areas via postcodes, the register enables analysis of how civil society provision varies across communities. Per-capita measures can be calculated by joining population estimates from the ONS mid-year estimates.
- **Longitudinal tracking.** The combination of registration dates, removal dates, and the linked financial datasets enables tracking of organisational lifecycles — from incorporation through growth, decline, and dissolution.
- **Cross-register linkage.** The UID system and matches file enable researchers to link the Organisation Register with other TCSS datasets, including charity financial records, Companies House accounts, CIC 36 community interest statements, CIC board of directors data, and public procurement records.
- **Sector mapping.** The SIC codes file enables industrial classification of Companies House organisations. Combined with the ICNPTSO charity classifications (available separately via the [UK Charity Activity Tags project](https://github.com/charity-classification/ukcat) (<https://github.com/charity-classification/ukcat>)), researchers can map the full breadth of civil society activity.

9. Citation & Licence

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Suggested Citation

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10. Changelog

Version	Date	Description
1.3	September 2026	Matching improvements on the same July 2026 source data; no register data were re-downloaded. Four changes. First, the Charity Commission for Northern Ireland publishes a company number for charities that are also registered companies, and earlier releases discarded it: only 655 numbers, inherited from a 2024 snapshot, had ever reached the matching stage. The column is now read from every download, converted to the Companies House <code>NI</code> format, and cleared where the published value cannot be a company number (placeholders such as <code>"0"</code> and <code>"999999"</code>, values too long to be company numbers, and non-numeric entries). Two declarations checked against Companies House and found to name a different company are excluded by name. Second, a new match type <code>name - ni charity</code> (1,811 links) links a Northern Irish company to the Northern Ireland charity of the same name where that name identifies exactly one organisation on each side, covering the majority of the register for which no company number is published. Third, a new match type <code>merge via bridge</code> (378 links) records organisations that were combined because a single third record matched two existing entries from different registers on strong enough evidence — the same name allowing for <code>"The"</code>, <code>"Ltd"</code> and <code>"Limited"</code>, or numbers published by the regulators themselves. Care-regulator evidence alone cannot combine two organisations, because a care provider's return often cites a charity alongside its trustee company. Fourth, the <code>companyid - coop mutual</code> rule now requires its counterpart to be a Companies House or Mutuals Public Register record, correcting matches where a Scottish charity number was read as an identically formatted Scottish company number. Consequences: the register holds 1,819 fewer rows, and every one of them is a record folded into an organisation that is still present — 1,395 Northern Irish companies folded into their Northern Ireland charities, and 240 Mutuals Public Register societies, 134 Companies House companies, 46 co-operatives and 4 Scottish charities folded into a same-body organisation by the new bridge rule or the co-operative fix. No organisation is lost: the names and addresses of the absorbed records are retained in the supplementary file, and their identifiers remain in the matches file. Registration dates move earlier for 1,604 organisations, because the spine records the earliest date across linked records and many charities are now linked to an older company. 43 organisations are shown as active again, because status follows the newest authoritative record once the records are linked. Two Northern Ireland charities are now classified as Community Interest Companies. 781,176 organisations (384,096 active, 397,080 removed); 139,862 links; 1,112,618 supplementary rows; 474,842 SIC rows.
1.2	July 2026	Matching improvement on the same July 2026 source data: the <code>name - housing</code> rule now also accepts an FCA Mutuals Public Register society as the counterpart for English and Scottish social-housing providers (previously only a charity-register record was eligible), reflecting that many registered providers of social housing are registered societies rather than charities. This adds a net 784 cross-register links and consolidates 611 housing-register records (610 Social Housing England, 1 Scottish Housing Regulator) into their existing Mutuals Public Register entries, whose names and addresses are retained in the supplementary file. Six current-status corrections and 35 registration-date revisions follow from the newly consolidated evidence. No organisation names, classifications (<code>cso_type</code> / <code>cso_subtype</code>) or CIC flags change, and the SIC file is byte-identical to v1.1. 782,995 organisations (385,515 active, 397,480 removed); 136,578 links; 1,108,831 supplementary rows; 474,843 SIC rows.

Version	Date	Description
1.1	July 2026	Full rebuild from refreshed register downloads (July 2026). Restores the historical co-operative, social-housing and care-register records lost when those registers' archived snapshots became unavailable: 281 organisations and ~4,100 cross-register links return, reconstructed from the v1.0 release and re-derived through the standard matching rules. Adds three identifier-based match types (<code>companyid - cqc</code> , <code>charityno - cqc</code> , <code>name - crossborder</code>) and correctness fixes to date comparison, address truncation and same-name over-merging. Current status is now controlled by the newest authoritative source record, correcting organisations that were wrongly shown as removed on the basis of stale historical snapshots. The build is fully deterministic: two complete builds under different hash seeds produce byte-identical output, and the release was accepted only after that cross-seed check. The subtype classifier was corrected to apply its rules in a documented first-match priority order, with name-based rules applied even when no usable five-digit SIC code exists; relative to the interim July candidate this changes <code>cso_subtype</code> for 14,687 organisations (no <code>cso_type</code> changes) and introduces the Professional / Trade Body subtype. The SIC file is reissued in an atomic format — exactly one four- or five-digit code per row, remapped to the final spine UID. Historical name/address variants from v1.0 that current register downloads no longer publish are carried forward into the supplementary file; redundant company-number match rows that merely restated an existing link with inferred evidence are suppressed. A matching defect found in final quality assurance was corrected before publication: an organisation whose only link was a shared company number previously became invisible to later matching, which could divert cross-border, care and Find that Charity links to the wrong organisation (most visibly, RNIB's Scottish registration was linked to an unrelated charity); such organisations now remain independently matchable, organisations are no longer findable under the names of company-number-only partners, and placeholder company numbers shared by four or more charities (e.g. the literal "12345678" in the CCEW register) are excluded from matching. The correction also recovered previously missed links. 783,606 organisations (386,122 active, 397,484 removed); 135,794 links; 1,108,256 supplementary rows; 474,843 SIC rows.
1.0	March 2026	Initial release: 770,923 organisations from 10 source registers

A1. Data Processing

Each source register uses different conventions for field names, encodings, date formats, and the treatment of alternative names and addresses. The pre-processing step for each source:

1. Identifies the primary name and address for each organisation (choosing the most recent where multiple iterations exist)
2. Stores alternative names, addresses, and dates in the supplementary file
3. Normalises names by removing leading/trailing spaces, collapsing consecutive internal spaces, and converting to uppercase
4. Normalises addresses by concatenating address lines and the postcode into a single string
5. Converts all dates to `dd/mm/yyyy` format

The eight primary sources are then combined into a single dataset. Organisations already present from a higher-precedence source are not duplicated; instead, any additional data is stored in the supplementary file. The project source code is available on [GitHub \(https://github.com/uk-third-sector-database/tso-database-builder\)](https://github.com/uk-third-sector-database/tso-database-builder).

A2. Source Precedence

When an organisation appears in multiple registers, the register with the highest precedence supplies the primary record (UID, name, address, dates) for the spine file. The precedence order is:

Order	Source	Code
1	Charity Commission for England and Wales	CHC
2	Scottish Charity Register	SC
3	Charity Commission for Northern Ireland	NIC
4	Mutuals Public Register	MPR
5	Companies House	COH
6	Co-operatives	COOP
7	Scottish Housing Regulator	SHR
8	Social Housing England	SHPE
–	Care Inspectorate Scotland	CIS
–	Care Quality Commission	CQC

Charity registers take precedence over Companies House, meaning that a charity with a Companies House registration will have a GB-CHC- or GB-SC- UID rather than a GB-COH- UID. The Companies House record will appear in the supplementary and matches files.

A3. Matching Algorithm

The deduplication process uses several strategies to identify organisations that appear in more than one register:

Matching by Company ID

The charity regulators (CCEW and OSCR) record the Companies House company number for charities that are also registered companies. This enables deterministic matching:

- CCEW charity records are matched to Companies House records via the company number
- OSCR records with a company identifier are matched to Companies House records
- Co-operatives UK records with a “Registered Number” are matched to the Mutuals Public Register or to Companies House. From v1.3 this rule requires the counterpart actually to hold that number as a Companies House or Mutuals record; previously a charity number in the same format (Scottish charity and company numbers are both `sc` followed by six digits) could be matched by mistake
- Where two CCEW charities share the same company number, they are linked as duplicates
- From v1.3, the Charity Commission for Northern Ireland’s own company-number field is used in the same way, linking Northern Irish charities to their `NI`-prefixed Companies House records

Matching by Normalised Name

Where two organisations in different registers share the same normalised name, they are tentatively matched subject to an additional condition. The match is confirmed if any of the following hold:

1. The organisation is in CQC data and the matched core organisation is flagged as having a CQC registration in CCEW data
2. The organisation is in the OSCR register and has a “cross border” flag indicating a match is expected with CCEW
3. The organisation is in the Scottish Housing Regulator, and the normalised name matches an OSCR or Mutuals Public Register record; or it is in Care Inspectorate Scotland and the normalised name matches an OSCR record

4. The organisation is in Social Housing England, and the normalised name matches a CCEW or Mutuals Public Register record; or it is in CQC and the normalised name matches a CCEW record
5. The organisation is a Northern Irish company (Companies House number beginning NI) and the normalised name matches a Northern Ireland charity record. Because a shared name is weaker evidence than a shared number, this condition applies only when the name identifies exactly one organisation on each side — one charity holding that name, and one Northern Irish company holding it

Matching via Find That Charity

A lookup table provided by [Find That Charity \(https://findthatcharity.uk/\)](https://findthatcharity.uk/) (David Kane) is used to generate additional matches. These links include historic re-registrations, allowing the dataset to be further deduplicated. This is the most common match type, accounting for 73,307 of the 139,862 total links.

Consolidating Two Records via a Bridging Record

Occasionally a single record matches two organisations that are already in the register under different source registers. From v1.3, where the evidence is strong enough, this is treated as proof that the two are one organisation and they are combined into a single record rather than left as two with a note of shared evidence between them. The combination is deliberately conservative: it applies only when the incoming record matches exactly two organisations, those two come from different registers, both are still independent records, neither link rests only on a shared company number recorded as an association, and either the two organisations carry the same name (allowing for “The”, “Ltd” and “Limited”) or each is identified by a number that a regulator itself publishes. The organisation from the higher-precedence register keeps the UID (see [Section A2](#)); the other organisation’s name, address and dates move to the supplementary file and it appears in the matches file with match type `merge via bridge`. Care-regulator records alone cannot trigger a combination, because a care provider’s return often cites a charity alongside its trustee company or trading subsidiary — a relationship, not an identity. This release combines 378 pairs of records in this way.

Determining the Primary Organisation

Where a match occurs between organisations from different sources, the higher-precedence source provides the primary record. Where a match occurs between organisations from the *same* source:

- For CCEW matches, the Find That Charity lookup identifies the “transferee” in a re-registration; the transferee is treated as primary
- Otherwise, the organisation without a removal date (i.e. still active) is primary; if both have removal dates, the one with the most recent removal date is primary
- If neither has a removal date, the organisation with the earliest registration date is primary

A4. Companies House Inclusion Criteria

Companies House records are filtered to include only company types relevant to the civil society sector. The following table lists all company categories and whether they are included or excluded from the register.

Included Company Types

Company Category
Charitable Incorporated Organisation
Community Interest Company

Company Category
Industrial and Provident Society
PRI/LBG/NSC (Private, Limited by guarantee, no share capital, use of 'Limited' exemption)
PRI/LTD BY GUAR/NSC (Private, limited by guarantee, no share capital)
Registered Society
Scottish Charitable Incorporated Organisation
Converted/Closed

Excluded Company Types

Company Category
Private Limited Company
Public Limited Company
Limited Partnership
Limited Liability Partnership
Scottish Partnership
Private Unlimited Company
Private Unlimited
Investment Company with Variable Capital (Umbrella)
Investment Company with Variable Capital (Securities)
Investment Company with Variable Capital
PRIV LTD SECT. 30 (Private limited company, section 30 of the Companies Act)
Overseas Entity
United Kingdom Economic Interest Grouping
United Kingdom Societas
Old Public Company
Other Company Type
Protected Cell Company
Royal Charter Company
Further Education and Sixth Form College Corps
Other company type

A5. Linking to Other TCSS Datasets

The Organisation Register serves as the backbone for the wider TCSS data ecosystem. The `uid` field enables direct linkage to the following companion datasets:

Dataset	Link Field	Description
Charity Financial Records	uid	Longitudinal income and expenditure data for registered charities (CCEW, OSCR, CCNI)
Nonprofit Financial Records	uid	Companies House accounts data for CICs and other nonprofit companies
CIC 36 Community Interest Statements	uid	Beneficiary descriptions, activities, and surplus use statements from CIC incorporation forms
CIC Board of Directors	uid	Board member records for CICs from Companies House officer filings
Procurement Records	uid	Public procurement contracts and grants awarded to civil society organisations

Tip: When linking charities to Companies House financial data, use the matches file to find the corresponding GB-COH- UID. A charity with UID GB-CHC-200009 may have a Companies House match at GB-COH-00686799 , and the financial data will be keyed on the Companies House UID.

This dataset guide was produced by the [UK Third and Civil Society Sector Database \(https://uk-third-sector-database.github.io/\)](https://uk-third-sector-database.github.io/) project, funded by the [ESRC and DCMS \(https://gtr.ukri.org/projects?ref=ES/X000524/1\)](https://gtr.ukri.org/projects?ref=ES/X000524/1), in collaboration with the Third Sector Research Centre at the University of Birmingham and partner institutions at the Universities of Southampton, Oxford, Stirling, and the West of Scotland.

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